

Step 2: Mark the boring but important tasks

These are the best candidates for agents. Do not begin with your most sensitive task. Begin with something repetitive and low-risk.

Step 3: Identify the data source

Is the task based on PDFs, emails, spreadsheets, web pages, meeting transcripts, CRM entries, WhatsApp messages, images or code files?

Step 4: Identify the output

Do you want a summary, table, email draft, checklist, presentation outline, cleaned spreadsheet, code file, ticket update or calendar plan?

Step 5: Choose the agent category

General-purpose for mixed tasks. Productivity for email and documents. Automation for app-to-app workflows. Coding for software. Business-platform for CRM or support. Local/private for sensitive data.

Step 6: Set permission levels

Begin with no access or read-only access. Add write access only after repeated success. Add send, publish, delete or purchase permissions only in rare cases, and preferably never for personal use.

Step 7: Create a test task

Use old, non-sensitive data. Ask the agent to perform the task. Compare the result with what you would have done manually.

Step 8: Improve the prompt

Add missing context, tone rules, formatting rules, examples and approval points.

Step 9: Save the workflow

Once it works, turn it into a reusable prompt, automation or agent instruction.

Step 10: Review monthly

Remove tools you do not use. Tighten permissions. Update prompts. Delete unnecessary data access.

Toolkit for students

For students, the ideal starter toolkit is a general-purpose agent plus a note-taking or document tool. The core uses are summarising chapters, generating flashcards, planning revision, explaining difficult concepts, checking essays and creating practice questions.

The danger is outsourcing learning. A student should ask the agent to teach, test and challenge, not simply produce assignments. A good rule: never submit anything you cannot explain yourself.

Toolkit for teachers

For teachers, agents can save enormous preparation time. They can create lesson plans, worksheets, quizzes, rubrics, parent messages, examples in local languages and differentiated explanations for weak and strong students.

The best tools are those that can adapt to grade level and language. Teachers should avoid uploading student personal data unless the tool is approved by the institution. Even then, use anonymised data wherever possible.

Toolkit for office professionals

For office professionals, the best toolkit depends on the work-

